provided important services. The federal and provincial governments did not have enough people to staff every position on their own. However, the decision to overlook those organizations operating under the JuD umbrella, but using different names, suggests that outward appearances were more important than actually reining in the group. Further, the oversight that did exist was never rigorous, and by most indications it became less so over time. JuD's continued legal status complicated matters, but so did its power in Punjab. It was not a political party, but JuD was and remains a political player. Its vast social welfare offerings and high public profile translated into influence with the population and some politicians depended on it to help deliver the vote banks they needed to remain in office. Beyond the ballot box, JuD intimidated politicians and police because of the well-trained and well-armed men at its disposal.

The security services made no attempt to dismantle the military apparatus that produced Lashkar's militants and which made the Mumbai attacks possible. Lashkar's infrastructure in Manserha, where some of the training for the Mumbai attacks took place, remained intact according to local journalists and interlocutors who arranged meetings for the author with Lashkar militants.[38] Authorities raided one of Lashkar's main camps outside of Muzaffarabad, which the army then occupied. However, according to one former fighter who remained in touch with the group, 'They sit there for the sake of the media, to show that Pakistan is acting against the LeT. But it's all just a game.' The camp had not really closed, only moved to a more discreet location, some 25 miles from Muzaffarabad. A sign pointed to a JuD-run school, but militants confirmed they were using the camp as a jumping off point for the Kashmir jihad. According to a journalist who visited it, police at a checkpoint nearby evinced a clear awareness of its location.[39] According to a government report seen by the Islamabad bureau of the BBC, the opening of this new camp was only part of a wider militant expansion in the months after Mumbai. A copy of the report, submitted by local police to Pakistan-administered Kashmir's cabinet on 25 March 2009, detailed militant activity by Lashkar, JeM and HuM in the city of Muzaffarabad and elsewhere in the region. When militants killed some of the locals it led to a stand-off that was resolved only when a local administrator and senior army officials intervened. The report recommended authorities take up the matter with 'the intelligence agency responsible for the militants.' Notably, it did not advocate any